

OFFICIAL PROGRAMME

Merge Film Festival 2026



1–4 October 2026

MASSAGNO

5 October · Bellinzona · Outside the festival

Thursday

1 OCTOBER 2026

One evening on the big screen.

20:30

20:30–23:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM

CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–

Opening ceremony · Memory of Princess Mumbi

The festival opens and the film begins immediately afterwards in the same auditorium. One ticket for the whole evening.

Competition screenings, out-of-competition screenings, opening and closing ceremonies: CHF 15.– per event, CHF 30.– day pass.
Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.
Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Friday

2 OCTOBER 2026

Private school sessions in the morning, followed by the first two competition programmes, the discussion and the Swiss awards. Piazza Grande is open from 18:00 to 01:00, with food and drinks.

09:00	09:00–13:00 · MASSAGNO SCHOOLS, AULA MAGNA AND CLASSROOMS 1–3 Workshops for middle schools Schools only Luca Botturi (SUPSI), Christian Montecchiani (SUPSI), Elena Battipede (SUPSI), Petra Mazzoni (SUPSI).
10:00	10:00–12:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Out of competition · WALL·E CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– Andrew Stanton, Pixar, 2008 · 98 min.
10:00	10:00–11:45 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Masterclass for arts high schools · Antonella Autuori (SUPSI) Schools only
14:00	14:00–15:30 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Masterclass for science high schools · Stefano Peduzzi (SUPSI) Schools only
14:00	14:00–15:30 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM In competition · Programme 1 CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– Seven short films, ≈ 60 min. Followed by a Q&A with the directors in person.
17:00	17:00–18:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM FORMA APERTA · Where does the creative process live? Free admission Open talk and launch of FORMA APERTA, with Felix Bachmann, Kevin Merz, Manuela Bachmann and Simona Gamba.
18:30	18:30–20:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Discussion with Alessandro Bavari and Dario Cirrincione Free admission Screening works by Alessandro Bavari: Cronache di Mare (WORLD PREMIERE), Artefatti, Raw War, The Freakpoint Range, UNKNOWN QUANTUM OBJECTS.
20:45	20:45 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Swiss Innovator Award · Swiss Press Award Included with the Programme 2 ticket
21:00	21:00–22:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM In competition · Programme 2 CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– Six short films, ≈ 60 min., with a Q&A with the directors in person.

Competition screenings, out-of-competition screenings, opening and closing ceremonies: CHF 15.– per event, CHF 30.– day pass.
 Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.
 Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Saturday

3 OCTOBER 2026

The busiest day: three competition programmes, a roundtable, a panel on the environmental impact of AI, a talk and the Critics' Award. Piazza Grande is open from 10:00 to 01:00, with food and drinks.

10:00	10:00–12:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Out of competition · Wider than the Sky CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– Valerio Jalongo.
10:00	10:00–13:00 · MASSAGNO SCHOOLS, AULA MAGNA CISA and USI lecture · Alessandro Bavari and Marco Longo Schools only
13:30	13:30–15:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM In competition · Programme 3 CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– Eight short films, ≈ 60 min. Followed by a Q&A with the directors in person.
14:00	14:00–15:00 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Roundtable Free admission With Marco Zaffalon, Colin Porlezza (USI), Javisth Chabria and Pierre Alexandre Tremblay. Moderated by Felix Bachmann (Centro Generativo). In collaboration with USI.
15:30	15:30–17:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM In competition · Programme 4 CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– Eight short films, ≈ 60 min. Followed by a Q&A with the directors in person.
16:00	16:00–17:00 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Panel: The environmental impact of AI Free admission With Prof. Silvia Santini (USI), Dr Marta Soprana (LSE IDEAS) and Elettra Fiumi. Moderated by Ilaria Espa.
17:30	17:30–19:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Talk · Javisth Chabria and Kevin B. Lee (USI) Free admission Moderated by Felix Bachmann (Centro Generativo). In collaboration with USI.
21:00	21:00–22:30 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Critics' Award and In competition · Programme 5 CHF 15.– / conc. 10.– The Critics' Award, followed by seven short films, ≈ 60 min., with a Q&A with the directors in person.

Competition screenings, out-of-competition screenings, opening and closing ceremonies: CHF 15.– per event, CHF 30.– day pass.

Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.

Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Sunday

4 OCTOBER 2026

The final out-of-competition screening, followed by the awards ceremony and a screening of the winning films immediately afterwards.

10:00

10:00–12:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM

Out of competition · title to be announced

We'll announce it soon.

CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–

15:00

15:00–16:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM

Awards ceremony and screening of the winning films

The awards are presented, immediately followed by a screening of the winning films.

CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–

Competition screenings, out-of-competition screenings, opening and closing ceremonies: CHF 15.– per event, CHF 30.– day pass.
Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.
Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Monday

5 OCTOBER 2026

The day after the closing ceremony the festival travels to Bellinzona as a guest of the Swiss {ai} Weeks. This one is outside the festival programme: free, in another town, and with a sign-up of its own.

16:00

16:00 · PALAZZO CIVICO, BELLINZONA · COUNCIL CHAMBER

Swiss {ai} Weeks · Memoria Viva

Free · sign-up required

Stories, voices and archives in the age of artificial intelligence. Merge brings a best of the 2026 selection, and artistic directors Dario Cirrincione and Francesco Poloni are in the room.

PROGRAMME

- 16:00** Welcome and opening remarks · Gaetano Biondo
- 16:15** Biography Library · Claudio Brignole
- 16:45** From Giorgino to Memoria Viva · Roberto Mazzantini
- 17:15** Screening · Giorgino and the dragon known as Oblivion
- 17:30** Discussion

Registration required: luma.com/jhp0ct2s

Guest event, outside the festival · Free · sign-up required

Memoria Viva is organised by Mazzantini & Associati SA and Biography Library within the Swiss {ai} Weeks, under the patronage of the Città di Bellinzona. Sign-up is confirmed by the organisers.